

KEY WORKS: Serenade for Strings, Op. 6, 1892; Asrael (symphony), Op. 27, 1906; Ripening (orchestra and chorus), Op. 34, 1917; Epilog (orchestra, soloists and chorus), Op. 37, 1929

Ottorino Respighi

1879–1936, ITALIAN

One of Italy's most popular composers, Respighi was born in Bologna and studied at the city's liceo musicale. As an orchestral viola player he spent time in Russia, where he was taught composition by Rimsky-Korsakov, whose flamboyant orchestration he adopted. He built up his early reputation chiefly as a composer of operas and concert pieces for voice and orchestra. From 1913, Respighi was based in Rome, where he taught at the St. Cecilia Academy and married the singer and composer Elsa Olivieri-Sangiaco in 1919. Largely indifferent to Modernism, Respighi cultivated an eclectic interest in musical history, writing orchestral suites based on old Italian lute pieces and using Rossini melodies for his 1919 ballet *La Boutique fantasque*. He discovered his most successful genre with the symphonic poem *Fountains of Rome* in 1916. Brash, colorful, and atmospheric, his three works on Roman themes earned